

PROGRESSION · TIMELINE · GRAPH

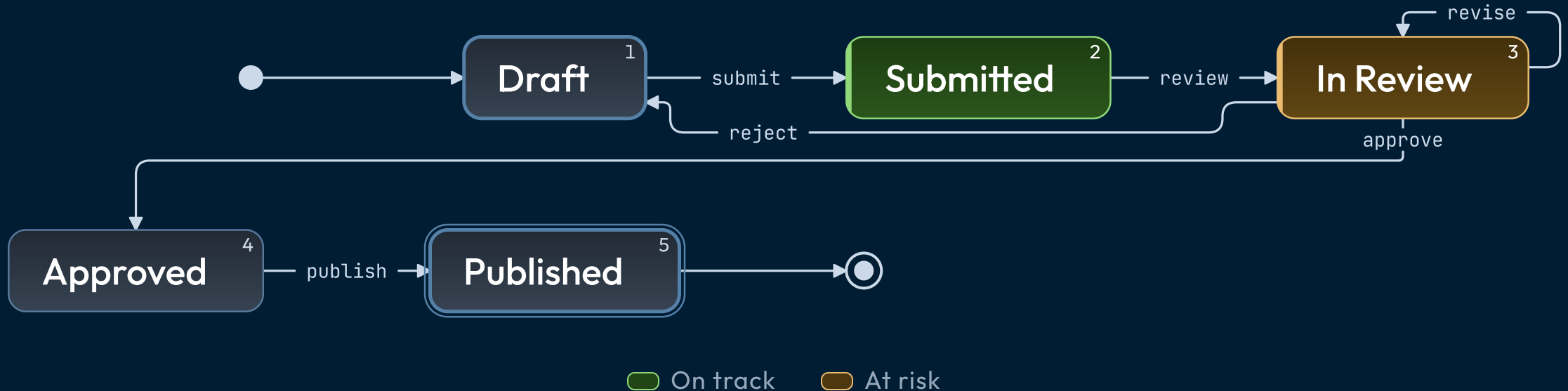
state-chart

Native state machine diagram — states as a list, transitions as arrows to a state's name, on the flowchart's grammar.

SUBMISSION LIFECYCLE

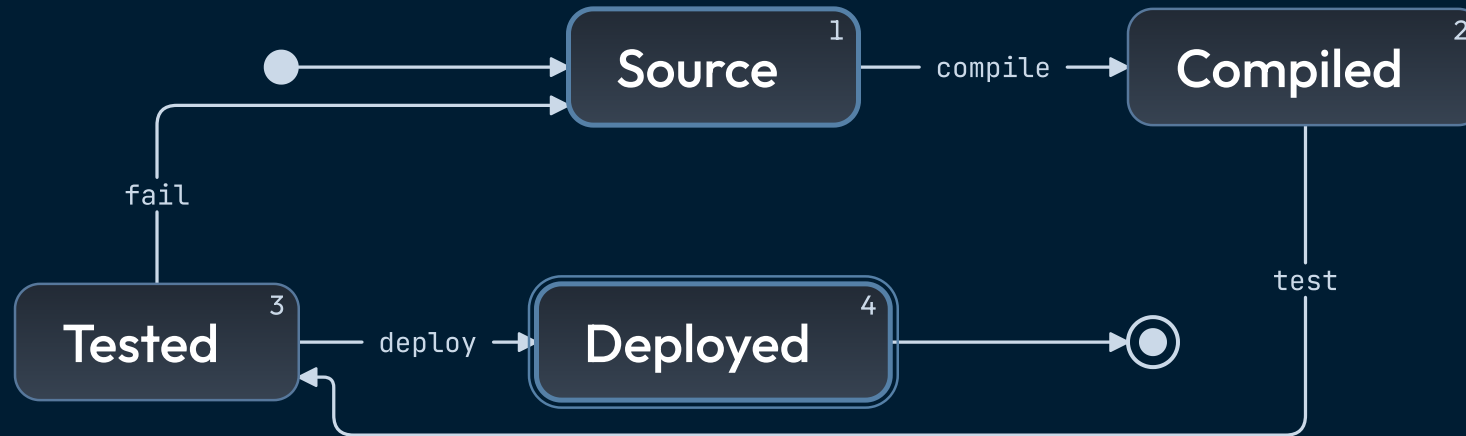
States connect; the arrows carry the rules.

How a draft moves from author to publication.



Rejected drafts return to the author; revisions stay in review.

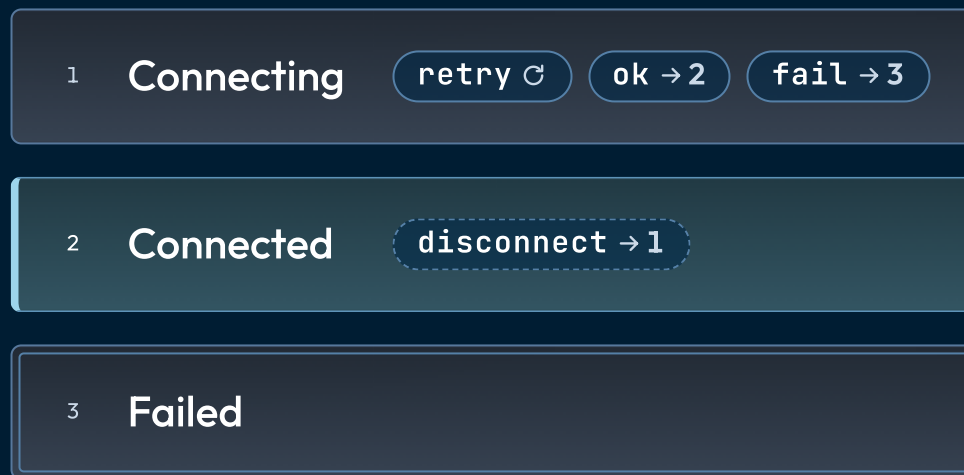
lr flows the states left to right.



tb stacks the states top to bottom.

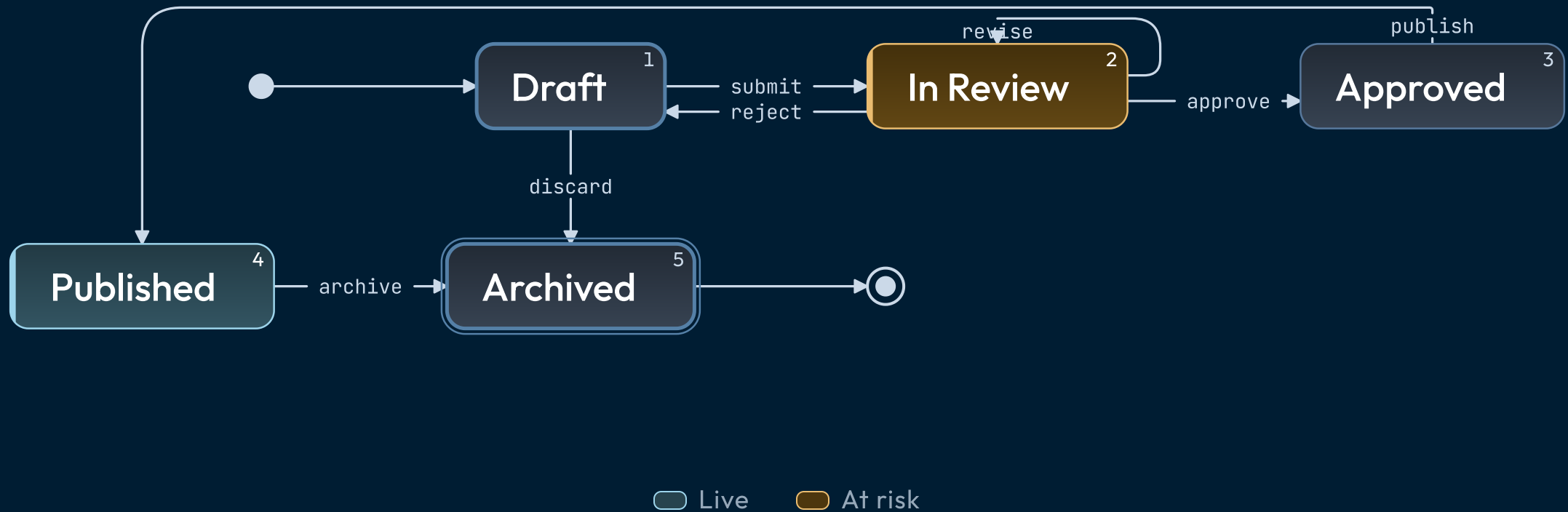


inline sets the chart beside its prose.



☐ Live

curved rounds the lines between states.



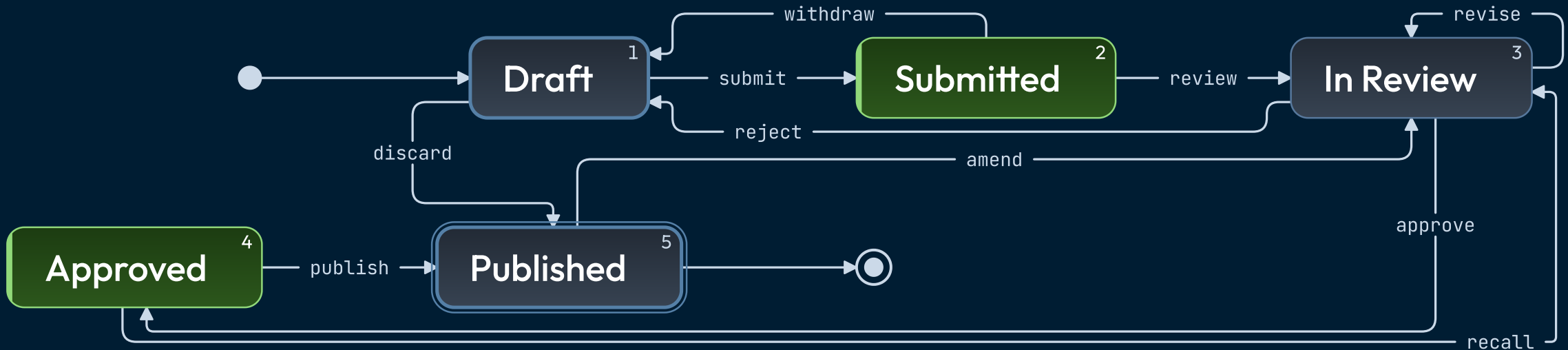
unnumbered drops the badges.



☐ Live

SUBMISSION LIFECYCLE

Stress test — back-edges, skips, self-loop.

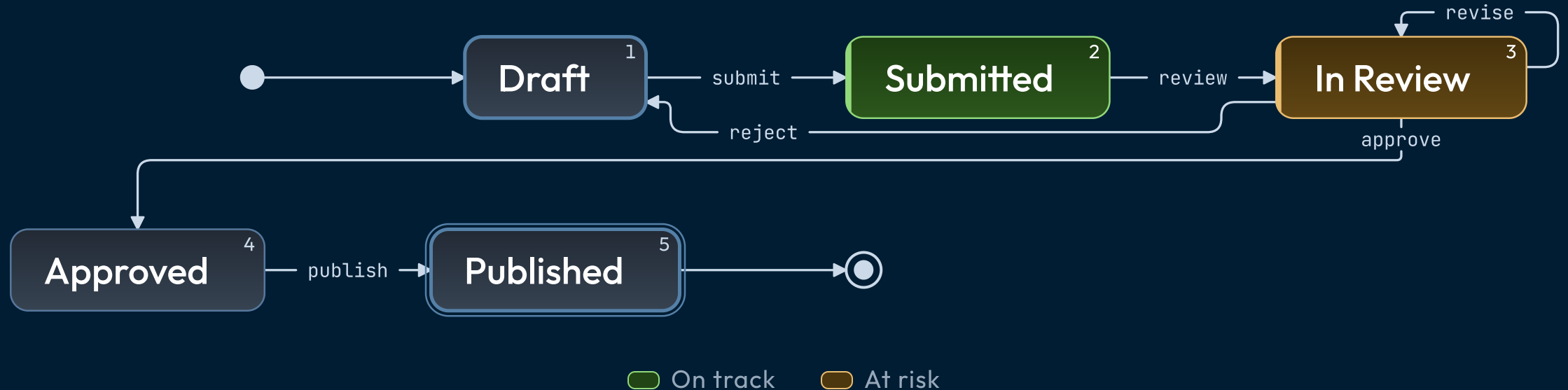


On track · Done

SUBMISSION LIFECYCLE

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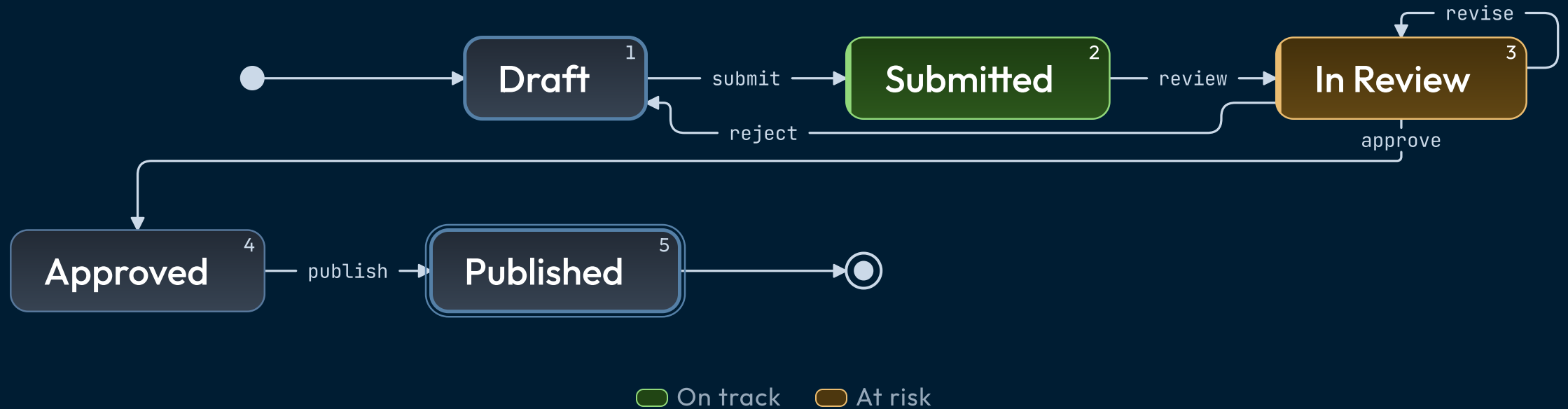


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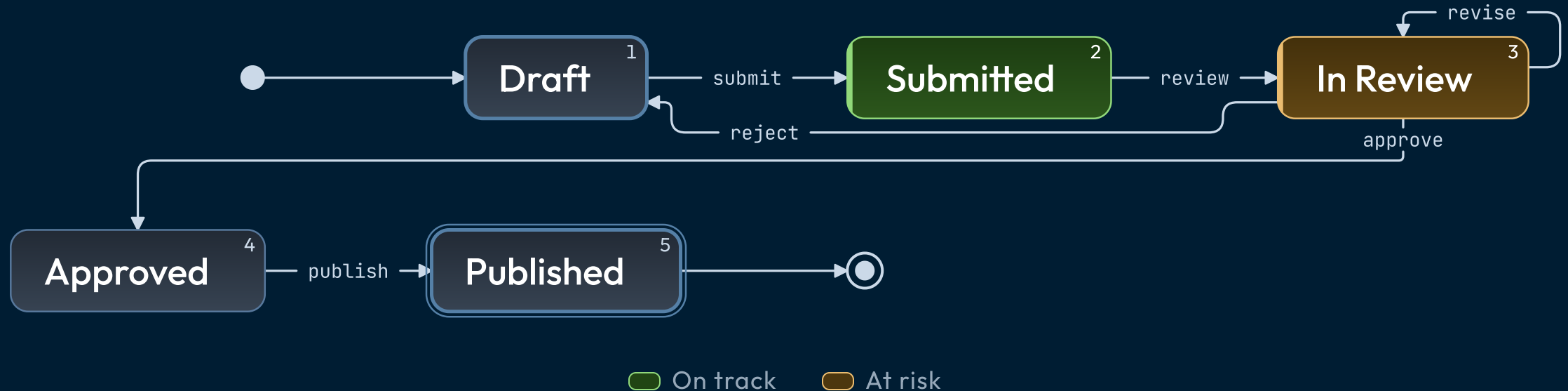


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When NOT to reach for state-chart.

More than ~12 states

A long chain wraps onto more lines rather than shrinking, so eight or ten states still read. Past about a dozen the machine stops reading as a machine and starts reading as a list, however it is laid out. Group the states into phases and show one phase at a time, or step back to a higher-level abstraction. The chart's job is to make the topology obvious in one glance.

When NOT to reach for state-chart.

Parallel regions, history or guards

A composite state is a sub-list of states, but orthogonal regions, history states and guard conditions are not in this grammar. Those belong in a Mermaid fence via the `diagram` component.

Continuous processes

If the diagram is really a workflow with stages that overlap or block (queue depth, throughput, capacity), a `gantt` or `kanban` chart reads better. State charts are for discrete, mutually-exclusive states the system flips between.

See also.

`diagram` — the machine has hierarchical states, parallel regions, or guards that need Mermaid's full state-diagram grammar

`journey` — the sequence is a user's path through tasks with mood / affect, not a system's discrete states

`timeline-list` — events are points in time rather than transitions between named states

`list-steps` — a linear procedure with no branching — state-chart is overkill if there are no choices to make

`roadmap` — parallel workstreams across phases, not a single machine's transitions